claim to Normandy and also agreed (for the second time) to surrender any claim to the French throne, a concession that also extended to his son the Black Prince.[13]

The compromise, signed at Bretigny on May 8, 1360, allowed John to return home. He entered Paris, after four years of imprisonment, to the sentimental relief of his people. This brought Charles of Navarre's hopes to a sharp end; seeing his supporters melt away, he retreated to Navarre.[14]

But the return of John II was not joyful. His second wife had died just before his arrival home. Paris was shabby and divided against itself. The countryside was infested with bandits. The treasury was empty, with three million crowns left to be found. The Dauphin Charles had lost his two daughters to illness within weeks of each other, and himself was suffering from a mysterious sickness that was causing his hair to fall out and his fingernails to shed.

John II was completely unable to talk the Estates-General into raising taxes for the payment of the ransom, and young Louis of Anjou, seeing no end to his captivity, escaped from Calais and made his way home. So in January of 1364, John himself announced that he would journey back to England to renegotiate the terms. He left the Dauphin Charles as regent in Paris; to his favorite son, the youngest, Philip the Bold, he gave Burgundy along with the title Duke of Burgundy. Louis of Anjou got nothing.

Edward welcomed the king of France in style and put him up at the Savoy Palace in London, the home of Prince John of Gaunt. But deliberations, says the contemporary *Chronicle of Canterbury*, "were delayed from day to day; and meanwhile the king of France remained at the Savoy without any final decision." Early in March, John came down with a severe and obscure ailment. On April 8, three months after his returned to London, he died at the Savoy Palace. He was forty-five years old.[15]

At this, Charles of Navarre "had hope," says Froissart. He sent a Navarrese army, under joint Navarrese and English command, into Normandy; Charles's biographer, the extraordinary Christine de Pisan, says that "three thousand men-at-arms" also began a march towards the Seine, intending to intercept Charles on the way to his coronation and prevent it. But the French royal army, pressing rapidly forward, met the invaders near the village of Cocherel, north of Paris. "There was much hacking and cutting with lances and battle-axes," remarks Froissart, ". . . [and] of the Navarrois but few escaped being slain or taken." Three days later, the Dauphin was crowned King Charles V of France.[16]

The Battle of Cocherel ended Charles of Navarre's last serious attempt to